

DAVIDSON COLLEGE

Department of Economics
Box 6941
Davidson, NC 28035-6941

Mark C. Foley, Ph.D.
Phone: (704) 894-2248
mafoley@davidson.edu

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Dear Hiring Committee Member:

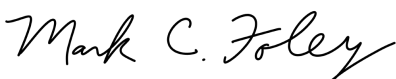
Andy Daileanes took my course at Davidson College in 2023 called Statistics and Basic Econometrics (Econ 204). Through formal class meetings, review sessions, and informal discussions, I had the opportunity to evaluate his academic work, observe his maturity and motivation, and assess his potential to succeed as an intern in a position requiring quantitative analysis and attention to detail. He is bright, very hard-working, intellectually curious, genuinely interested in economics and quantitative analysis. I **strongly recommend** him for summer internships that would benefit from these skills and abilities.

Andy did very strong work in my course, which was an applied course in statistics and econometrics, with a blend of both statistical theory and empirical applications. The course moves fast as we started with basic probability concepts, discrete and continuous distributions, mathematics of expectations, sampling, one-and two-sample hypothesis tests, and moving all the way through OLS, properties of estimators, and conditions for causal inference in econometric models. He was able to keep up and impressed me by the quality of his questions. And these were questions that showed he had prepared beforehand, by which I mean they were not simply clarifying questions or questions about the lecture material. He did have some of those of course, but he also asked “big picture” questions about why we use certain estimators or do certain hypothesis tests.

In addition, Andy was highly invested in the independent semester-long, regression analysis research paper that I have students write. This is a 21-page paper with all the components of an academic article from motivation, literature review of peer-reviewed publications (although I tell them some working papers are very highly quality – like NBER working papers), econometric model development, data and descriptive statistics section, correlation coefficient hypothesis testing, power calculations for reasonable true effect sizes, OLS regression results (only 2 independent variables allowed in this course – the 2nd required quant course in the economics majors relaxes this), interpretation, omitted variable bias analysis (that wouldn’t be in a regular academic paper necessarily, but I have them do it to demonstrate their understanding), limitations section, and a conclusion. He was very diligent about working on the paper as the semester progressed (he’s not a procrastinator!), and wrote a great paper entitled “The Effect of the NBA Bubble Environment on 3-Point Percentage.” He created his own dataset from Basketball Reference and StatMuse on the 131 players who attempted at least 30 three-point shots in the bubble and in the prior regular season. His OLS regression analysis estimated that playing in the bubble decreased players’ 3-point percentage by 0.28 percentage points. Andy’s review of related literature was among the most detailed and comprehensive that I have seen in this course. For example, he dove into the nuances and details of a paper about the effect of being away from one’s family during the bubble (Paulsen and Boucot, *Managerial and Decision Economics*, 2023), presenting a superb summary of its methodology and results, including citing specific numerical estimates which many students do not take the time to do. I will highlight one other aspect of his research paper, and that was the discussion of which significance level to use for his hypothesis tests. Andy’s discussion of Type I and Type II errors, in particular the inverse relationship, demonstrated a deep understanding of the real-world implications from inferential statistics and hypothesis testing. I was impressed.

Finally, I will share that Andy is a calm, mature, and affable person, who is respectful of me and others in my observations. Andy would be a terrific member of any work team and make positive contributions to the overall goals. In short, without reservation, I strongly recommend Andy for quantitatively-oriented summer internships.

Sincerely,



Mark C. Foley, Ph.D